Apex Systems — Supplier RFP Response

Fictional classroom sample — not a real supplier proposal

Strong technical architecture and security posture; higher price and a moderate delivery schedule.

1. Executive Summary and Technical Capability

Proposes a modular cloud-native architecture with documented REST integrations, horizontal scaling, API gateway, monitoring, and disaster recovery. Provides a detailed integration diagram and load-testing approach.

The supplier understands the requirement to deliver a maintainable solution, integrate with existing systems, and support operational growth. All claims should be validated during due diligence.

2. Implementation Plan

Estimated delivery is 16 weeks. A named project manager and solution architect are allocated part time. Milestones cover discovery, design, build, integration testing, security review, and launch. Migration risk is acknowledged with a rollback plan.

Dependencies include timely access to business stakeholders, test environments, and approved interface documentation. Final dates depend on discovery and acceptance of the project plan.

3. Commercial, Security, Support and Experience

Commercial proposal: Fixed implementation fee: $240,000. Annual support: $36,000. Pricing includes integration testing and training but excludes third-party licenses and taxes. Change requests are billed separately.

Security and compliance: Describes encryption in transit and at rest, role-based access control, centralized audit logs, annual penetration testing, incident response, and alignment with ISO 27001 controls. Certification status is described as planned, not currently certified.

Support and experience: Business-hours support with a 1-hour response target for critical incidents. Two comparable projects are described, but reference contact details are available only on request.

This fictional proposal is intentionally designed with strengths, limitations, and unanswered questions to support a classroom evaluation exercise.